

THE STRIDE A full stride can cover 25 feet of ground

HEAD: The typical big cat skull is here retooled to make space for a huge cluster of optic nerves–aiding 5-km vision–hence a smaller, weaker jaw



LEGS: Longer and leaner than those of other cats. The legs also contain spring-like ligaments

PAWS: Narrow, with a hard underside fitted with ridges that act like tyre treads. Claws are blunt, slightly curved, mostly non-retractable and act like running spikes. All specialised to increase sprint traction

2.5 FT HEIGHT

3.5 FT-4.5 FT BODY

THE FASTEST FEET FIRST



120 KMPH CHEETAH



72 KMPH GREYHOUND



64 KMPH RACE HORSE



45 KMPH USAIN BOLT

SPEED MACHINE 0-60 MPH

3.1 SECONDS (FERRARI)



3.0 SECONDS (CHEETAH)



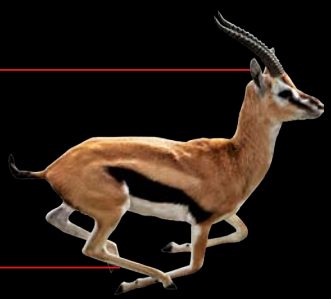


Grouping: Cheetahs live as 'coalitions' of males, females with cubs or individually

Gestation period: Three months

Litter: They give birth to three or four cubs that attain independence in around 18-20 months

FOOD: Gazelles, impalas, other small- to medium-sized ungulates and calves of larger ungulate species are the primary diet, apart from hares, small mammals and birds



HABITAT Cheetahs are found in a range of habitats–from shrublands, grasslands and savannahs to temperate and hot deserts



2022 India and Namibia sign an MoU to bring in the cheetah; the first lot of 8 animals to arrive at Kuno Palpur

2021 Feasibility studies are carried out again in MP and Rajasthan for the animal's introduction

2020 The SC finally clears the cheetah introduction project

2017 The National Tiger Conservation Authority seeks a clarification from the SC, while arguing the 2013 order did not impose a blanket ban

2013 The SC quashes the cheetah introduction plan, terming it arbitrary and illegal

2012 The Supreme Court (SC), hearing a plea on the proposed translocation of Asiatic Lions from Gir, Gujarat, to Kuno Palpur in MP, stays the project

2009 Experts from across the world meet in Gajner, Rajasthan, to discuss the introduction of the African cheetah in India, at the invitation of Union minister for environment and forests Jairam Ramesh. A task force is set up

Source: From various websites